

NUMERICAL METHODS

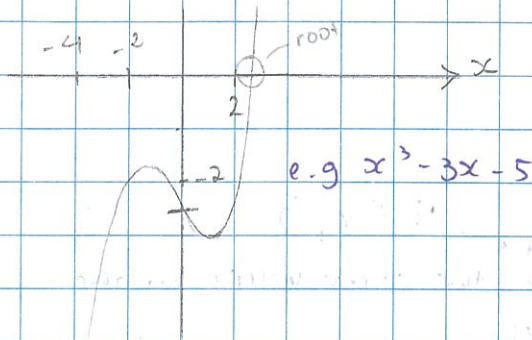
PURE

NUMERICAL METHODS FOR SOLVING EQUATIONS

Some equation cannot be solved using conventional algebra:

'Numerical methods' of solving means 'trial and error'

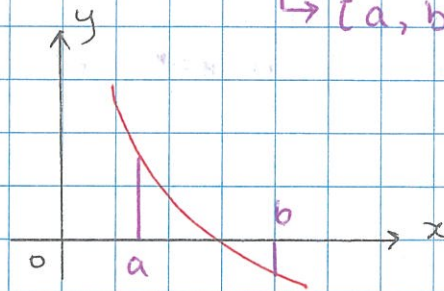
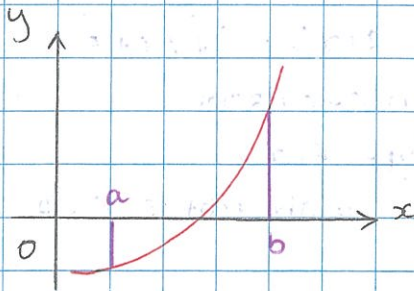
i.e. try - check - improve - try - check - improve



THE SIGN-CHANGE RULE

If $f(x)$ is continuous in an interval $a \leq x \leq b$ and if $f(a)$ and $f(b)$ have opposite signs, then $f(x)$ has at least one root between a and b

→ $[a, b]$ $[2, 5]$
 $2 \leq x \leq 5$



Eg. Show that $f(x) = x^3 - 3x - 5$ has a root in the interval $[2, 3]$

Show that $f(2)$ and $f(3)$ have opposite signs

$$\begin{aligned} f(2) &= (2)^3 - 3(2) - 5 \\ &= 8 - 6 - 5 = -3 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} f(3) &= 3^3 - 3(3) - 5 \\ &= 27 - 9 - 5 = +13 \end{aligned}$$

Since $f(2)$ and $f(3)$ have opposite signs, $f(x)$ must have a root with $[2, 3]$

The $x = f(x)$ method

To solve the equation $f(x) = 0$.

1. Rearrange $f(x) = 0$ into $x = F(x)$
2. choose a suitable starting value for x call this x_1
3. Calculate $F(x_1) \rightarrow$ Capital F
4. Let $x_2 = F(x_1)$
5. Calculate $F(x_2)$
6. Let $x_3 = F(x_2)$
7. Calculate $F(x_3)$
8. continue this process letting $x_{r+1} = F(x_r)$
9. Stop when x_{r+1} and x_r have the same value to the required number of decimal places

Example 1: solve $x^3 - 3x - 5 = 0$ correct to 2 d.p. Give the result of each iteration.

$$f(x) = x^3 - 3x - 5$$

$$1. x^3 - 3x - 5 = 0$$

$$x^3 = 3x + 5$$

$$x = \sqrt[3]{3x + 5} \rightarrow F(x)$$

Trick: use **Ans** key

$$F(x) = \sqrt[3]{3x + 5}$$

on calculator **2** **=** (Starting value)

Type $F(x)$

$$\sqrt[3]{} \text{ () } 3 \times \text{Ans} + 5 \text{ () } = 2.2239...$$

$$2. x_1 = 2$$

	x	$F(x)$	
3	$x_1 = 2$	$F(2) = 2.223980091$	
4	$x_2 = 2.223980091$	2.2684 5	2.27
5	$x_3 = 2.2684$	2.277 7	2.28
	$x_4 = 2.277$	2.279	2.28
9	$x_5 = 2.279$	2.279	2.28

↑
keep pressing =
it will give the ans

So, the root is $x = 2.28$ (2dp)

Example 2:

(i) show that the equation $x^3 - x - 2 = 0$ has a root between 1 and 2

(ii) The equation is rearranged into the form $x = F(x)$ where

$$F(x) = \sqrt[3]{x+2}$$

use the iterative formula suggested by this rearrangement to find the value of the root to 3 decimal places

(i) $f(1)$ and $f(2)$ have opposite signs

$$f(1) = 1^3 - 1 - 2 = -2 \quad f(2) = 2^3 - 2 - 2 = 4$$

$f(1)$ and $f(2)$ have opposite signs so $f(x)$ has a root in $[1, 2]$

(ii) $x_1 = 1$ type in calculator

$$x_2 = 1.4422$$

$$x_3 = 1.5099$$

$$x_4 = 1.5197$$

$$x_5 = 1.5211$$

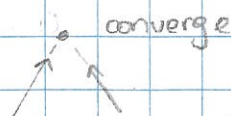
$$x_6 = 1.5213$$

$$\text{So, } x = 1.521 \text{ (3dp)}$$

CONVERGING and DIVERGING VERSIONS OF $F(x)$

If the values given by the formula $F(x)$ get closer and closer, the formula is said to converge.

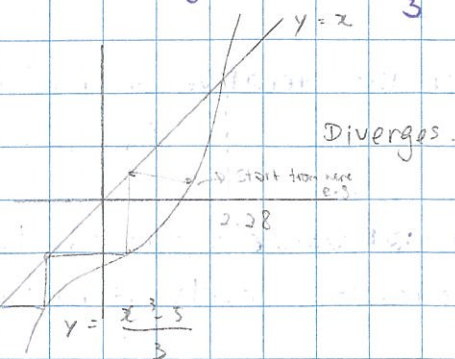
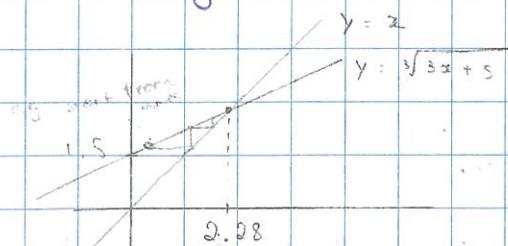
So, the formula $F(x) = \sqrt[3]{3x+5}$ converges



$$\text{Solve } x^3 - 3x - 5 = 0$$

$$\text{rearrange to } x = \sqrt[3]{3x+5}$$

$$\text{also rearrange to } x = \frac{x^3 - 5}{3}$$



How do you know that Formula 1 is converge

of diverge? $\rightarrow$ compare gradient of 2 lines

$m < 1$ Converge $m > 1$ diverge

$$x^3 - 3x - 5 = 0$$

it also rearranges to $x = \frac{x^3 - 5}{3}$

$F(x)$ values get further and further apart. This is said to be Diverges.

So, the formula $F(x) = \frac{x^3 - 5}{3}$ diverges.

In general, the $F(x)$ formula will converge to the root, if the gradient to $F(x)$ near the root is between 1 and -1. Otherwise, diverges.

Generally these formulas will converge:

- Square roots, cube roots, 4th roots etc
- logs and natural logs
- e^{-x}
- Inverse trig

using graphs to find an approximate location of the root
(a common Cambridge question)

Example:

1. (i) By sketching a suitable pair of graphs, show that the equation $2 \cot x = 1 + e^x$, where x is in radians, has only one root in the interval $0 < x < \frac{1}{2}\pi$.

(ii) verify by calculation that this root lies between 0.5 and 1.0

(iii) show that this root also satisfies equation

$$x = \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{2}{1 + e^x} \right)$$

(iv) use the iterative formula

$$x_{n+1} = \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{2}{1 + e^{x_n}} \right)$$

with initial value $x_1 = 0.7$, to determine this root correct to 2 d.p.

Give the result of each iteration to 4 d.p.

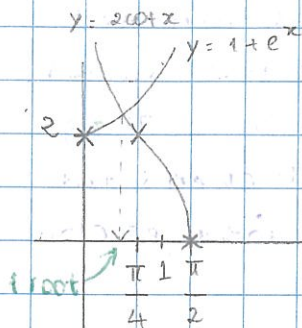
Ans

(i) $f(x) = 0$

$$2 \cot x - 1 - e^x = 0$$

$$y = 2 \cot x$$

$$y = 1 + e^x$$



(iii) $x = \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{2}{1 + e^x} \right)$

$$\frac{2}{\tan x} = \frac{1 + e^x}{1}$$

$$\frac{\tan x}{2} = \frac{1}{1 + e^x}$$

$$\tan x = \frac{2}{1 + e^x}$$

$$\tan x = \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{2}{1 + e^x} \right)$$

(ii) $2 \cot x - 1 - e^x = 0$

$$f(0.5) = \frac{2}{\tan(0.5)} - 1 - e^{0.5} = 1.0122541$$

$$f(1) = \frac{2}{\tan(1)} - 1 - e^1 = -2.434096$$

Since $f(0.5)$ and $f(1)$ have opposite signs, So, there must be a root in $[0.5, 1]$

(iv) $\boxed{0.7} \boxed{=}$

$$\tan^{-1} \left(2 \div (1 + e^{\text{ANS}}) \right) =$$

$$x_1 = 0.7$$

$$x_2 = 0.5859$$

$$x_3 = 0.6208$$

$$x_4 = 0.6101$$

$$x_5 = 0.6134$$

$$x_6 = 0.6124$$

$$x_7 = 0.6127$$

$$x_8 = 0.6126$$

$$\text{So, } x = 0.61 \text{ (2dp)}$$